FEATURE · TABLE REFLOW

Responsive tables

A table that runs out of width changes shape instead of squeezing.

A record list in a narrow pane becomes one card per row.

THE TEAM

Ada Okafor

ROLE Engineering lead

CITY Lagos

Priya Raman

ROLE Design director

CITY Bengaluru

Tomás Ruiz

ROLE Product manager

CITY Madrid

WHAT CHANGED

Each row is one person, so each becomes a card. The first cell is the card's title; every other cell is a label and its value. Nothing in the source changed: the engine read the table as a record list and the pane's width did the rest.

A two-column table puts each label above its value.

THE APPLIANCE

THROUGHPUT
40 Gb/s sustained

POWER DRAW
180 W typical

FOOTPRINT
1U, 43 cm deep

WARRANTY
Five years

WHAT CHANGED

A spec sheet reads in pairs. Side by side, the value column would be a few characters wide; stacked, each value gets the pane's full width.

In a half pane the same table stays a table.

THE TEAM

NAME	ROLE	CITY
Ada Okafor	Engineering lead	Lagos
Priya Raman	Design director	Bengaluru
Tomás Ruiz	Product manager	Madrid

WHY IT DID NOT SWITCH

A slide does not grow, and a card is taller than the row it replaces. So a table switches only where it genuinely breaks. A half pane on a 16:9 slide is wide enough, so nothing moves, and neither does a table on a full-width slide.

A quarterly table splits into runs of columns, labels repeated.

REVENUE

	Q1	Q2
Revenue	40	45
Margin	61%	62%

	Q3	Q4
Revenue	51	58
Margin	62%	63%

WHAT CHANGED

Each row is a measure and each column a quarter, so the reader compares both ways. Cards would break that. Instead the quarters split into blocks of two, and each block repeats the row labels, so Q1 still sits beside Q2. A cross-tab (region by product) takes the same layout; at the narrowest, one column per block.

An option table becomes one block per option.

PLANS

STARTER	
Per seat	$12
Support	Email
TEAM	
Per seat	$24
Support	Chat
SCALE	
Per seat	$48
Support	Phone

WHAT CHANGED

Each column is an option, and the reader weighs one option at a time against the same criteria. So each option becomes a block, and every block lists the criteria beside its values.

A ranked list keeps rank, name and figure on one line.

TOP ACCOUNTS

RANK	ACCOUNT	ARR
1	**Northwind** SECTOR Logistics	1,240
2	**Contoso** SECTOR Retail	980
3	**Fabrikam** SECTOR Industry	860

WHAT CHANGED

The reader scans a ranking down the rank, the name and the figure. Those three stay on the first line; the other columns move to a second line under the name, each with its label.

A schedule puts each date above its milestone.

THE MIGRATION

12 JAN

Freeze the schema

OWNER Ada

2 FEB

Dual-write

OWNER Tomás

23 FEB

Backfill

OWNER Nia

WHAT CHANGED

A schedule reads as a sequence of dates. Each date becomes a small heading over its milestone, and the owner follows as a labeled line.

Three lists in one table become three lists.

THE REVIEW

STRENGTHS

- Strong API
- Loyal base

GAPS

- Onboarding
- Mobile app

RISKS

- Pricing
- Key person

WHAT CHANGED

The columns share nothing but the row they happen to sit on, so each becomes its own list. Detection cannot tell this kind from a record list, so the author names it with `table-lists`.

An author can keep the table with one word.

THE TEAM

NAME	TEAM	SINCE
Ada	Core	2019
Priya	Design	2021
Tomás	Product	2020

THE OVERRIDE

`no-table-reflow` on the pane's marker keeps this table at every width, here a short one that fits as a table. On a slide without panes it goes in the slide's class. `table-cards`, `table-pairs` and `table-lists` force a layout instead.